

4. Who decided the quarrel ?

5. What happened to the thief ?

TAIL-PIECE

- Read another interesting story very similar to the one you have read just now.

A WISE KING

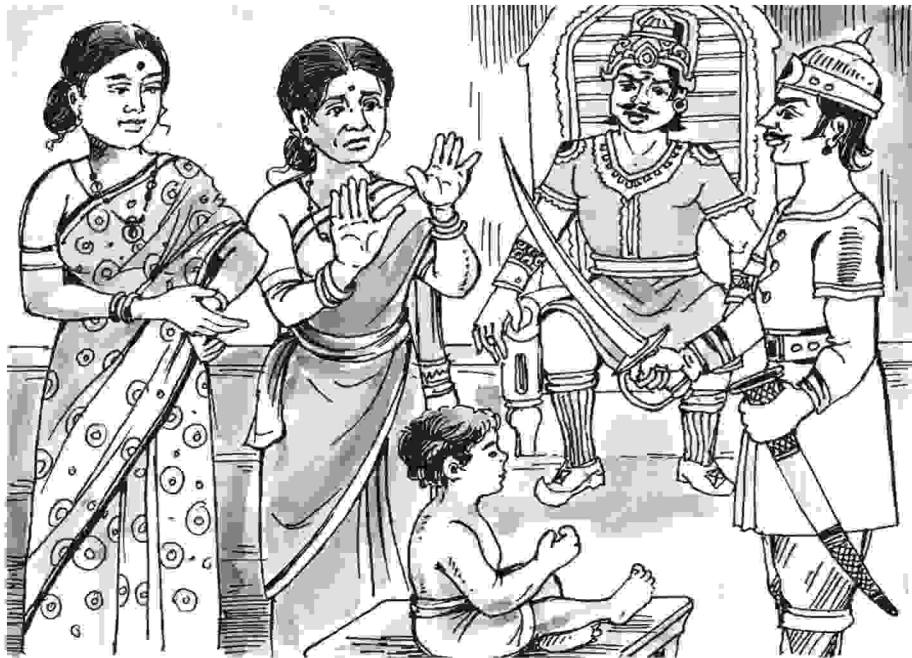
Once there was a king. His name was Vikram. He was a very wise king.

One day two women came to the king : Sita and Laxmi. They were sisters. They had a baby with them .

“ Please let me have the baby,” Sita said to the king. “ I’m his mother”.

“No, I’m his mother ,” said Laxmi, “ Please give him to me”.

King Vikram thought for a minute. Then he said to a servant, “Bring me the sword”.



The man brought a sword.

"Whose baby is this?" the king asked the women.

"He's my baby," said Sita.

"He's my baby," said Laxmi.

"Cut the baby into two. Give one half to Sita and the other half to Laxmi".

Suddenly Sita began to cry. "Please do not kill the baby," she said. "Give him to Laxmi. But let him live".

"Give the baby to Sita," the king said. "She's his mother".

The king said to Laxmi, "You're a liar. I'll punish you".

"Sir," said Sita, "Don't punish my sister".

The king did not punish Laxmi.

The women went away happily.

Word Note

get off (opposite : get on) : climb down from a horse, ଓହ୍ଲେଇବା, ଅବତରଣ କରିବା

lame : not able to walk properly because of an injury to the leg, ଛୋଟା

take off (opposite: put on) : remove clothes etc., ଯୋଷାକ ଦେହରୁ କାଢ଼ିବା

turban : a covering for the head worn by Muslims or Sikh men, ପଗଡ଼ି

Tail-piece

Punish(opposite: reward) : to make one suffer for the wrong s/he has done, ଦଣ୍ଡଦେବା